Teen-Driver Family Agreement Card

A signed, expected-of-everyone agreement — kindness with a signature, not rules delivered at the door.

What this is

A two-page printable your family fills in together, signs together, and keeps in the sun visor. It's not a punishment tool: it's a shared agreement where everyone — parent and teen — has written promises. That's what makes it stick.

How to use it

1. Set aside 30 relaxed minutes together (not in the driveway before a first solo drive).
2. Fill in both “The driver promises” and “The grown-up promises” — the reciprocity is the whole trick. Teens agree to rules when adults agree to trust and to be reachable, no questions asked, 2 a.m. included.
3. Both of you sign. Both keep a copy: visor + kitchen corkboard.
4. Review it at 3 months, and renegotiate anything that isn't working — for either side.

Reminder: your state has **graduated driver license (GDL) laws** — passenger limits, night curfews, phone rules. Check your state's DMV page and copy those into this card as the baseline; then the card adds your family's layer on top.

Printing tips: card stock for the copy that lives in the visor. Keep the tone warm when filling it in — this is a safety pact, not a contract for court. If a promise can't be kept on a bad day, it's the wrong promise; shrug and rewrite it.

Teen-Driver Family Agreement

Filled in together. Signed by both. Lives on the visor and the kitchen wall.

NEW DRIVER	PARENT / GUARDIAN ON THIS PACT
LICENSE STAGE (LEARNER / RESTRICTED / FULL)	STREET-LEGAL PER STATE (GDL) CURFEW + PASSENGER LIMITS

The driver promises

- [ ] No phone in hand or lap while driving, ever — it lives in the ___ until parked (GPS set before the wheels move)
- [ ] Everyone buckles before the key moves — back seat included, no exceptions, every ride
- [ ] Zero alcohol, cannabis, or any impairment, and I won't ride with anyone who has
- [ ] No extra passengers during the restricted period (state limit or the family number: ___)
- [ ] Obey curfew hours: _____
- [ ] Speed limits are the floor for attention, not a target for the needle — especially in rain, night, and neighborhoods
- [ ] If I feel too tired, angry, or rushed to drive safely, I'll text first and take the slow option or wait
- [ ] Fuel stays above a quarter tank — no coasting in on the light, and I never let it hit empty
- [ ] Any ding, scrape, weird noise, or warning light gets reported the same day — small problems stay small when told early
- [ ] Gas money, toll money, chores tied to keys, curbside food runs — our family's extras are listed here: _____

The grown-up promises

- [ ] My “come get me, no questions tonight” call is always answered — judgment can wait until morning, and I'll owe you my calm
- [ ] When you make a small honest report of a problem you caused or noticed, we solve it together — you're thanked, not ambushed
- [ ] I will not use your mistakes as stories at family dinners
- [ ] My phone stays silent in my pocket when I'm teaching you to drive
- [ ] Random GPS-tracking liberties are not part of this deal (or our agreed version of it: _____)
- [ ] Freedom and trust grow when promises hold on both sides — starting small: _____

Signatures

DRIVER, SIGNED & DATED

PARENT/GUARDIAN, SIGNED & DATED

WE REVIEW THIS ON (DATE): _____

Verify with your manual: the state's GDL rules and your car's manual (belt reminders, airbag warnings about front-seat passengers under 13, and “how to set the mirrors” basics) are the ground this agreement stands on.